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First Time Home Buyer



We've all made big purchases. We've all scrimped and saved. Maybe it was for a new bike as a kid, a tropical vacation, perhaps a brand-new car. Well, none of that compares to buying a house.

Nothing compares to the scale of responsibilities and benefits of owning your own home. Those four walls do more than just house your stuff and protect you from the elements. **When utilized to its fullest, owning a home can fortify and stabilize your finances and can help provide for your family's future.**

The road to purchasing a home for the first-time buyer might seem dizzying at first. It's fair to say the average first-time buyer probably hasn't seen that many zeroes on a price tag that they are actually considering signing for. While the whole process may seem daunting, we hope to make it easy and understandable.

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There is a staggering amount of variables to consider...location, schools, insurance, extra space to grow if you're planning on having a family, inspections, neighbors, home condition, and more. **Our advice is to create a plan to tackle one thing at a time.** It won't be easy but keep a level head and don't allow yourself to feel overwhelmed. Let's get started.

Consider what you can afford. Make sure you consider the full cost of borrowing money. That means reviewing your specific loan's terms and asking your lender about the interest, fees, and other costs associated with your loan.

Many first-time buyers will even limit themselves to mortgages slightly below what they could actually afford.

Your next steps are vital before placing an offer on any available property.

Find Lenders

Loan type

Refinance

Property type

Single Family

Credit Rating

Good: 640 - 720

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By Paul Parcellin, Staff Writer

March 6, 2014



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February 10, 2014



Reading Good in the Neighborhood

Neighborhood

- Consider the best loan type for your situation. That is, whether a fixed or adjustable rate mortgage is better suited for your current financial situation.
- Research which neighborhoods and homes are within your price range.
- Once you've seen a number of homes you will begin to realize what you're willing to live with and what conditions you'll consider deal breakers. **If you're looking at an older home you will need to set aside some money for repairs and upgrades.**
- Talk with your friends and family about budgeting for unexpected expenses that may occur after buying your first home. Consider outlining a plan for expenses that arise in the months after moving in.
- Consult with your insurance agent to make sure you have the insurance portion of the home sale locked down.

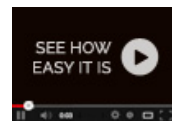
These simple steps could help propel you along the path to home ownership. During the process it is important to remember that this is a large, life-changing purchase. **There will be headaches and hurdles but all of it may culminate in one of the most satisfying accomplishments in life, home ownership.**

The Consumer Finance Protection Bureau (CFPB) compiled a list of counselors that can help you in the process of purchasing your first home. Please reference their website for more details: <http://www.consumerfinance.gov/find-a-housing-counselor/>



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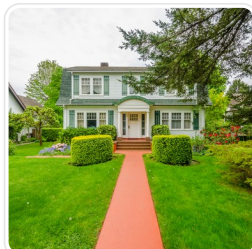
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